

Document 20: Hepatitis - Types and Prevention

Hepatitis refers to inflammation of the liver, most commonly caused by viral infections. The main types are hepatitis A, B, C, D, and E, each with different modes of transmission and health impacts. Hepatitis A and E are typically spread through contaminated food and water, while B, C, and D are transmitted through blood and bodily fluids. Symptoms may include jaundice, fatigue, abdominal pain, and nausea. Chronic hepatitis B and C can lead to liver cirrhosis and cancer. Prevention includes vaccination (for hepatitis A and B), safe injection practices, screening of blood products, and public education on hygiene and safe behaviors.